

Chapter 24 — "Spot the Niphal" Passage Exercise

Genesis 37, 44, 45, 47, 49 · The Joseph Narrative

Most highlighted verbs are Niphal forms. For each one, first answer Is it Niphal? (Yes / No). If Yes: parse conjugation, PGN, and root, then state the semantic function (Passive / Reflexive / Simple Action). If No: identify the correct stem and parse fully. Three verbs in Part C are not Niphal — drawn from Qal already studied. Answer key begins on the page marked "Answer Key".

Passage A — Genesis 37:7, 36

37:7

וַהֲנִיחָהּ קִמָּה אֶלְמָתִי וְגַם נִצְבָּה

"and behold, my sheaf arose and [1] ____."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	נִצְבָּה				

37:36

וְהַמִּדְיָנִים מָכְרוּ אֹתוֹ ... וַיִּמָּכֶר יוֹסֵף אֶל-מִצְרַיִם

"Now the Midianites had sold him ... and Joseph [2] ____ into Egypt."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
2	וַיִּמָּכֶר				

Passage B — Genesis 44:9–20

44:9

אֲשֶׁר יִמָּצָא אֹתוֹ מִעֲבָדֶיךָ וּמֵת

"With whichever of your servants [3] ____ [the cup] shall die."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
3	יִמָּצָא				

44:12

וַיִּמָּצָא הַגִּבִּיעַ בְּאִמְתַּחַת בְּנִימִן

"And the cup [4] ____ in Benjamin's sack."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	וַיִּמָּצָא				

44:20

יֵשׁ לָנוּ אָב זָקֵן וַיֵּלֶד זָקָנִים קָטָן וְאָחִיו מֵת וַיֵּיתֶר הוּא

"We have an aged father ... his brother is dead, and he alone [5] ____."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
5	וַיֵּיתֶר				

Passage C — Genesis 45:1, 16

45:1

וְלֹא־יָכַל יוֹסֵף לְהִתְאַפֵּק לְכָל הַנֹּצְבִים עָלָיו

"Joseph could no longer control himself before all those [6] _____ near him."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	הַנֹּצְבִים				

45:16

וַהֲקִיל בְּשִׁמְעָה בֵּית פַּרְעֹה לֵאמֹר בָּאוּ אֶחָיו־יוֹסֵף

"And the report [7] _____ in Pharaoh's household, 'Joseph's brothers have come.'"

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
7	בְּשִׁמְעָה				

Passage D — Genesis 47:14, 31

47:14

וַיִּלְקֹט יוֹסֵף אֶת־כָּל־הַכֶּסֶף הַנִּמְצָא בְּאֶרֶץ־מִצְרַיִם

"And Joseph collected all the silver [8] _____ in the land of Egypt."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	הַנִּמְצָא				

47:31

הַשֹּׁבְעָה לִי וַיֵּשְׁבַע לוֹ

"[9] _____ to me." And he [10] _____ to him."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
9	הַשֹּׁבְעָה				
10	וַיֵּשְׁבַע				

Passage E — Genesis 49:1, 29, 33

49:1

הָאָסֹפִי וְאֶגִּידָה לָּכֶם

"[11] _____ and I will tell you."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
11	הָאָסֹפִי				

49:29

אֲנִי בָאֶסֶף אֶל־עַמִּי

"I am [12] _____ to my people."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
12	נִאָסָה				

49:33

וַיִּאָסֶה אֶל-עַמּוּיוֹ

"and he was [13] _____ to his people."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
13	וַיִּאָסֶה				

Bonus — Exodus 19:12

19:12

וְהִשְׁמַרְתֶּם ... הַשְּׁמֶרֶת לָכֶם

"And you shall [B1] _____ ... [B2] _____ for yourselves."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
B1	וְהִשְׁמַרְתֶּם				
B2	הַשְּׁמֶרֶת				

Part C — Distractor Check

These three verbs come from the same passages. None are Niphal. Answer "No" for Niphal? and complete the full parse.

37:7

וְהִנֵּה קִמָּה אֵלַי

"and behold, my sheaf [14] _____."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
14	קִמָּה				

37:36

וְהַמִּדְיָנִים מְכָרוּ אוֹתוֹ

"Now the Midianites [15] _____ him."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
15	מְכָרוּ				

45:1

וְלֹא-יָכַל יוֹסֵף לְהִתְאַפֵּק

"Joseph [16] _____ no longer control himself."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
16	יָכַל				

Items 12–13 (יָבֹרַךְ / יָבֹרַךְ) are both from יָבֹרַךְ — the euphemism "gathered to one's people" means death. Items 9–10 both parse as Reflexive from יָבֹרַךְ — notice Imperative followed by Wayyiqtol in the same verse (Gen 47:31).

Score: 13 Niphal + 3 non-Niphal + 2 bonus = 18 total. 15–18 = excellent | 11–14 = review the paradigm | below 11 = revisit §24.3

Conjugation Coverage

Conjugation	Verbs
Wayyiqtol (5)	#2, #4, #5, #10, #13
Participle (3)	#6, #8, #12
Imperfect (1)	#3
Perfect (2)	#1, #7
Imperative (3)	#9, #11, B2
Weqatal (1)	B1
Non-Niphal (3)	#14 (Qal Perf 3fs), #15 (Qal Perf 3cp), #16 (Qal Perf 3ms)

Reflection Questions

- Several Niphal forms of יָבֹרַךְ in this passage describe Jacob's death (Gen 49:29, 33). What does the passive "to be gathered to one's people" suggest about ancient Israelite views of death?
- In Gen 47:31, both יָבֹרַךְ (imperative) and יָבֹרַךְ (wayyiqtol) appear together. How does the narrative sequence reinforce the solemnity of Jacob's deathbed request?
- Compare יָבֹרַךְ in Gen 37:7 (Reflexive — sheaf stands itself upright) with יָבֹרַךְ in Gen 45:1 (Reflexive participle — servants stationed before Joseph). Is the reflexive force the same in both? What does each communicate about agency?

Answer Key

Passages with correct answers shown in the green row below each verb.

Passage A — Genesis 37:7, 36

37:7

וַהֲרֹה קִמָּה אֶלְמָתִי וְגַם נִצָּבָה

"and behold, my sheaf arose and [1] ____."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	נִצָּבָה				see ↓
✓	נִצָּבָה	Perfect	3fs	נצב	Reflexive — it stood upright (stationed)

37:36

וְהַמִּדְיָנִים מָכְרוּ אֹתוֹ ... וַיִּמָּכֶר יוֹסֵף אֶל־מִצְרַיִם

"Now the Midianites had sold him ... and Joseph [2] ____ into Egypt."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
2	וַיִּמָּכֶר				see ↓
✓	וַיִּמָּכֶר	Wayyiqtol	3ms	מכר	Passive — he was sold

Passage B — Genesis 44:9–20

44:9

אֲשֶׁר יִמָּצֵא אֹתוֹ מֵעַבְדֶּיךָ וּמָת

"With whichever of your servants [3] ____ [the cup] shall die."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
3	יִמָּצֵא				see ↓
✓	יִמָּצֵא	Imperfect	3ms	מצא	Passive — is found

44:12

וַיִּמָּצֵא הַגִּבִּיעַ בְּאִמְתַּחַת בְּנִימִן

"And the cup [4] ____ in Benjamin's sack."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	וַיִּמָּצֵא				see ↓
✓	וַיִּמָּצֵא	Wayyiqtol	3ms	מצא	Passive — was found

44:20

יֵשׁ לָנוּ אָב זָקֵן וַיֵּלֶד זָקָנִים קָטָן וְאָחִיו מֵת וַיֹּתֵר הוּא

"We have an aged father ... his brother is dead, and he alone [5] ____."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
5	וַיֵּזַח				see ↓
✓	וַיֵּזַח	Wayyiqtol	3ms	יֵזַח	Passive/Middle — was left, remained

Passage C — Genesis 45:1, 16

45:1

וְלֹא־יָכַל יוֹסֵף לְהִתְאַפֵּק לְכָל הַנֹּצְבִים עָלָיו

"Joseph could no longer control himself before all those [6] ____ near him."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	הַנֹּצְבִים				see ↓
✓	הַנֹּצְבִים	Participle	mp	נָצַב	Reflexive — those standing (stationed)

45:16

וְהַקֵּל נִשְׁמַע בֵּית פַּרְעֹה לְאֹמֶר בָּאוּ אֶחָיו־יוֹסֵף

"And the report [7] ____ in Pharaoh's household, 'Joseph's brothers have come.'"

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
7	נִשְׁמַע				see ↓
✓	נִשְׁמַע	Perfect	3ms	שָׁמַע	Passive — was heard

Passage D — Genesis 47:14, 31

47:14

וַיִּלְקֹט יוֹסֵף אֶת־כָּל־הַכֶּסֶף הַנִּמְצָא בְּאֶרֶץ־מִצְרַיִם

"And Joseph collected all the silver [8] ____ in the land of Egypt."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	הַנִּמְצָא				see ↓
✓	הַנִּמְצָא	Participle	ms	נָמַצַּא	Passive — that was found

47:31

הַשְּׂבָעָה לִי וַיִּשְׁבַּע לוֹ

"[9] ____ to me." And he [10] ____ to him."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
9	הַשְּׂבָעָה				see ↓
✓	הַשְּׂבָעָה	Imperative	2ms	שָׁבַע	Reflexive — swear! (bind yourself by
10	וַיִּשְׁבַּע				see ↓
✓	וַיִּשְׁבַּע	Wayyiqtol	3ms	שָׁבַע	Reflexive — he swore (bound himself by

Passage E — Genesis 49:1, 29, 33

49:1

הָאָסְפּוּ וְאֶגִּידָה לָכֶם

"[11] ____ and I will tell you."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
11	הָאָסְפּוּ				see ↓
✓	הָאָסְפּוּ	Imperative	2mp	אָסַף	Passive — gather yourselves!

49:29

אֲנִי נֹאסֵף אֶל-עַמִּי

"I am [12] ____ to my people."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
12	נֹאסֵף				see ↓
✓	נֹאסֵף	Participle	ms	אָסַף	Passive — am about to be gathered

49:33

וַיֵּאָסֶף אֶל-עַמּוֹ

"and he was [13] ____ to his people."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
13	וַיֵּאָסֶף				see ↓
✓	וַיֵּאָסֶף	Wayyiqtol	3ms	אָסַף	Passive — was gathered (died)

Bonus — Exodus 19:12

19:12

וְהִשְׁמַרְתֶּם ... הִשְׁמַרְוּ לָכֶם

"And you shall [B1] ____ ... [B2] ____ for yourselves."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
B1	וְהִשְׁמַרְתֶּם				see ↓
✓	וְהִשְׁמַרְתֶּם	Weqatal	2mp	שָׁמַר	Reflexive — take heed for yourselves
B2	הִשְׁמַרְוּ				see ↓
✓	הִשְׁמַרְוּ	Imperative	2mp	שָׁמַר	Reflexive — take heed! (guard)

Part C — Distractor Check

These three verbs come from the same passages. None are Niphal. Answer "No" for Niphal? and complete the full parse.

37:7

וַהֲנֵה קִמָּה אֶלְמָתִי

"and behold, my sheaf [14] ____."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
14	קִמָּה				see ↓
✓	קִמָּה	Perfect	3fs	קוּם	NOT Niphal — Qal: she/it arose (no ■-)

37:36

והַמִּדְיָנִים מָכְרוּ אוֹתוֹ

"Now the Midianites [15] ____ him."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
15	מָכְרוּ				see ↓
✓	מָכְרוּ	Perfect	3cp	מָכַר	NOT Niphal — Qal: they sold; no ■■-

45:1

וְלֹא-יָכֹל יוֹסֵף לְהִתְאַפֵּק

"Joseph [16] ____ no longer control himself."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
16	יָכֹל				see ↓
✓	יָכֹל	Perfect	3ms	יָכַל	NOT Niphal — Qal: he was able;

Items 12–13 (■■■■■■■■ / ■■■■■■■■■■) are both from ■■■■■■ — the euphemism "gathered to one's people" means death. Items 9–10 both parse as Reflexive from ■■■■■■ — notice Imperative followed by Wayyiqtol in the same verse (Gen 47:31).

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